

At Men's Ministry, we hope to create an environment of servanthood, to one another and to others outside of CCF.

This year, we want to cultivate a spirit of servanthood among the men in CCF, a mindset that sees others as worthy of our service and finds true joy in putting their needs before our own. On our own, this is impossible. Our flesh naturally seeks self-interest, using people to advance our goals rather than serving them with love. Too often, even as Christians, we serve out of obligation rather than genuine care or a desire to honor God. Over time, servanthood slips into the background of our lives as we buy into the world's lies and place academics, career, or personal pleasure above all else. But Jesus modeled a radically different way of living. Though He was in very nature God, He humbled Himself, taking the posture of a servant for our sake, even while we were still sinners. He showed us that it is truly more blessed to give than to receive. Our goal in Men's Ministry this year is to encourage this attitude, humbly submitting ourselves before God so that we can serve each other with sincerity, humility, and genuine love.

*For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many.*

Mark 10:45

This service is only possible through humility and the surrender of yourself. In our hearts, many of us want to do great things and be successful. The Bible tells us that while it is not sinful to desire to be great, kingdom greatness is achieved by those who reveal the character of God, who so completely and utterly served us. In God's kingdom, those who love most through service are considered the greatest. Our hearts will always desire what we have made the most valuable in our lives, and we will always pursue what is true. Without true surrender to God that cultivates a mindset of humility, servanthood is not possible. At Men's Ministry this year, we hope to develop a culture of surrender and humility through allowing people to experience and receive the genuine love of Christ, so that they themselves can serve and display that genuine love freely, and in love present themselves as living sacrifices. And in the end, we hope that when the entirety of Men's Ministry can adopt this mindset of lowering oneself to elevate others, it can create complete transformation and revival, not only in our ministry, but in all of CCF and beyond!

*The greatest among you will be your servant. For those who exalt themselves will be humbled, and those who humble themselves will be exalted.*

Matthew 23:11-12

*Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven*

Matthew 5:3

We hope to express our willingness to serve others through our actions, moving beyond just words to demonstrate our care for one another in tangible ways. This means being more intentional in seeking opportunities to carry the burdens of our ministry, fellowship, and local community. We aim not to perform grand acts of service that seem transactional and convenient, but to serve actively from hearts filled with the love of Christ, a naturally sacrificial

form of love that consistently meets the real needs of others. We believe God's love is most visible when we choose to step outside of our comfort zone, laying down our convenience to enter into the needs of those around us. This year, we aim to build this culture of intentional service, where every man feels supported and spurred on to act out his love for others.

*By this we know love, that he laid down his life for us, and we ought to lay down our lives for the brothers. But if anyone has the world's goods and sees his brother in need, yet closes his heart against him, how does God's love abide in him? Little children, let us not love in word or talk but in deed and in truth.*

1 John 3:16-18

*And let us consider how to stir up one another to love and good works, not neglecting to meet together, as is the habit of some, but encouraging one another, and all the more as you see the Day drawing near.*

Hebrews 10:24-25